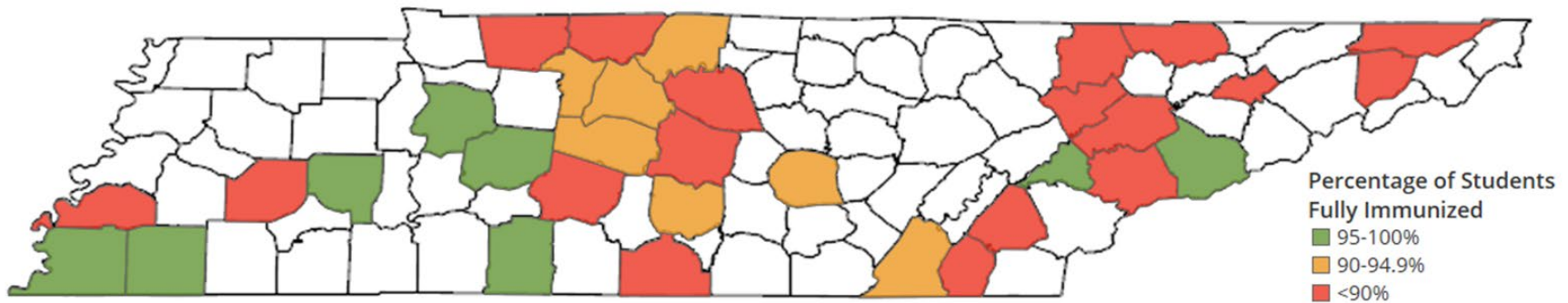


Figure 8. Percentage of 2023-2024 Private-School Students Fully Immunized by County, Tennessee



Note: 194 out of 266 private schools completed the 2023-2024 Kindergarten Assessment; this may influence the percentage of students fully immunized within each county.

Public School Statewide Summary

Of the 1,049 public schools surveyed during the 2023-2024 Kindergarten Assessment, 962 (91.7%) responded. Statewide, 93.0% of public-school kindergartners were fully immunized at the time of the survey (65,079 of 69,955 students). Students who were not fully immunized fell into the following categories, in decreasing order of prevalence (Note: arrows and corresponding figures represent the percent change greater than 0.1% between 2022-2023 and 2023-2024 assessments, if applicable).

- | | | |
|--------------------------|----------------|--------|
| • Religious Exemption: | 3.2% (n=2,245) | ↑ 0.3% |
| • Incomplete Record: | 1.1% (n=745) | ↑ 0.1% |
| • Missing Record: | 0.4% (n=266) | ↑ 0.1% |
| • Temporary Certificate: | 2.1% (n=1,462) | ↔ |
| • Transfer <30 days: | 0.1% (n=56) | ↔ |
| • Medical Exemption: | 0.0% (n=94) | ↓ 0.1% |

Private School Statewide Summary

Only 90.2% (4,727 of 5,243 students) of kindergartners enrolled in private schools were fully immunized, which represents a 0.9% decrease in the fully immunized rate when compared to the previous year. Unlike the public-school Kindergarten Assessment which uses Department of Education student rosters, private schools lack centralized enrollment lists. Thus, we are not able to ascertain how many private school students had immunization certificates that were validated by TennIIS. Although the response rate remains stable among private schools, with 187 (70%) of 266 private schools responded to the Kindergarten Immunization Compliance Assessment, there was a shift towards enrollment in private schools with an all-time high of 7% during 2023-2024.

Private school enrolled kindergartners who were not fully immunized fell into the following categories, in decreasing order of prevalence (Note: arrows and corresponding figures represent the percent change greater than 0.1% between 2022-2023 and 2023-2024 assessments):

- Religious Exemption: 6.6% (n= 346) ↑ 1.6%
- Incomplete Record: 1.6% (n= 82) ↔
- Missing Record: 1.2% (n=62) ↑ 0.1%
- Medical Exemption: 0.0% (n=7) ↓ 0.3%
- Temporary Certificate: 0.4% (n=19) ↓ 0.5%
- Transfer <30 days: N/A for private schools based on data collection methods

Conclusion

For Tennessee to reduce the risk of vaccine-preventable disease outbreaks, awareness and action are needed to maintain and increase childhood immunization. These efforts are critical to ensuring safe environments in schools. Medical providers are encouraged to review immunization records and provide catch-up immunizations at every opportunity. Thank you for partnering to protect public health in Tennessee.

Questions and comments regarding this report or the Kindergarten Assessment may be directed to School.Imm@tn.gov.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read "John R. Dunn".

John R. Dunn, DVM, PhD
State Epidemiologist
Communicable and Environmental Diseases and Emergency Preparedness
Tennessee Department of Health

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read "Caitlin N. Newhouse" with a small "MD" superscript.

Caitlin N. Newhouse, MD MPH
Medical Director, Vaccine-Preventable Diseases and Immunization Program
Communicable and Environmental Diseases and Emergency Preparedness Division
Tennessee Department of Health

Appendix 1: Percent Complete by County Table

To remain at low risk for a VPD outbreak the immunization rate should remain at or above 95.0% to control highly infectious diseases such as measles according to the CDC⁷. In the maps above and tables below, TDH categorized an immunization rate of at least 95% as “meets immunization goal” (green), an immunization rate of 90% to 94.9% as “needs improvement” (yellow), and an immunization rate below 90.0% as “places the community at increased risk” (red).

For detailed Kindergarten Assessment results at the county, school districts, and school levels, please see the Public-School Districts (SD) by County Summary section below in **Appendix 2**.

Table 1. Percentage of public and private school students fully immunized, total # students, and the number of schools with students fully immunized within each color category, by county, in descending order by “% students fully immunized” (Color Key: <90%; 90-94.9%; 95-100%)					
County	Students Fully Immunized in County (%)	Students in County	Schools with 95-100% Students in County Fully Immunized	Schools with 90-94% Students in County Fully Immunized	Schools with <90% Students in County Fully Immunized
HOUSTON	98.9%	93	2	0	0
SEQUATCHIE	98.2%	170	1	0	0
OBION	98.2%	386	5	1	0
FAYETTE	98.1%	359	5	1	0
BLEDSON	97.6%	127	2	1	0

⁷ <https://www.cdc.gov/media/releases/2022/p1123-measles-threat.html>

County	Students Fully Immunized in County (%)	Students in County	Schools with 95-100% Students in County Fully Immunized	Schools with 90-94% Students in County Fully Immunized	Schools with <90% Students in County Fully Immunized
GRAINGER	97.4%	230	4	0	0
MACON	97.3%	365	2	1	0
OVERTON	97.0%	231	4	1	0
COCKE	96.9%	382	8	1	1
GREENE	96.9%	445	8	1	0
STEWART	96.6%	148	2	0	0
DYER	96.4%	448	4	2	0
WEAKLEY	96.3%	300	4	1	0
CAMPBELL	96.2%	391	7	1	1
SCOTT	96.1%	311	4	1	1
JOHNSON	95.9%	147	3	1	0
LAKE	95.9%	49	1	0	0
RHEA	95.9%	343	4	1	0
MARION	95.9%	340	4	1	0
UNICOI	95.8%	165	3	0	1
HENRY	95.7%	350	3	1	0
HARDEMAN	95.7%	207	2	4	0
COFFEE	95.6%	613	7	3	0
MORGAN	95.5%	202	3	1	1
CARTER	95.5%	488	4	6	0
CARROLL	95.3%	297	3	2	0

County	Students Fully Immunized in County (%)	Students in County	Schools with 95-100% Students in County Fully Immunized	Schools with 90-94% Students in County Fully Immunized	Schools with <90% Students in County Fully Immunized
CROCKETT	95.3%	212	3	2	0
SMITH	95.0%	222	3	2	0
CUMBERLAND	95.0%	443	4	4	0
HAYWOOD	95.0%	161	1	0	1
HUMPHREYS	95.0%	221	2	2	0
FRANKLIN	95.0%	379	4	2	1
WAYNE	94.9%	136	1	2	0
ROANE	94.6%	467	4	2	1
TIPTON	94.6%	747	2	5	1
DEKALB	94.6%	205	1	0	1
WASHINGTON	94.5%	1,129	12	8	2
SULLIVAN	94.5%	1,105	11	3	5
ANDERSON	94.4%	898	10	4	3
DICKSON	94.4%	498	3	5	0
HAWKINS	94.3%	512	6	2	2
WARREN	94.3%	476	5	3	3
MCMINN	94.3%	564	5	4	2
BENTON	94.3%	140	2	0	1
BEDFORD	94.3%	717	4	4	1
HICKMAN	94.3%	209	2	1	0
SHELBY	94.2%	11,377	86	60	25

County	Students Fully Immunized in County (%)	Students in County	Schools with 95-100% Students in County Fully Immunized	Schools with 90-94% Students in County Fully Immunized	Schools with <90% Students in County Fully Immunized
HANCOCK	94.1%	68	0	1	0
CHEATHAM	93.8%	226	2	1	1
HENDERSON	93.5%	372	4	4	1
WILSON	93.5%	2,005	9	8	6
MADISON	93.5%	1,139	8	5	4
SUMNER	93.4%	2,284	12	17	5
HARDIN	93.2%	264	1	3	1
PERRY	93.2%	73	0	2	0
WHITE	93.1%	288	4	0	1
LINCOLN	92.9%	281	2	1	2
CANNON	92.8%	152	1	1	1
CLAY	92.8%	69	1	1	0
KNOX	92.5%	4,613	24	29	19
ROBERTSON	92.5%	876	4	6	2
RUTHERFORD	92.4%	4,416	13	19	13
SEVIER	92.3%	1,129	5	5	4
GIBSON	92.2%	567	5	1	3
MONROE	92.2%	500	3	2	1
LOUDON	92.1%	529	4	2	3
MONTGOMERY	92.0%	2,719	6	14	8
MEIGS	91.9%	124	0	2	0

County	Students Fully Immunized in County (%)	Students in County	Schools with 95-100% Students in County Fully Immunized	Schools with 90-94% Students in County Fully Immunized	Schools with <90% Students in County Fully Immunized
WILLIAMSON	91.8%	2,986	10	20	14
BLOUNT	91.7%	1,220	8	3	10
MOORE	91.7%	72	0	1	0
LAWRENCE	91.5%	576	3	6	2
PUTNAM	91.5%	869	2	2	6
JEFFERSON	91.3%	471	1	4	3
DAVIDSON	91.3%	7,908	42	37	42
MARSHALL	91.2%	431	0	2	1
GILES	91.2%	249	0	1	2
TROUSDALE	90.7%	97	0	1	0
CLAIBORNE	90.5%	317	3	4	2
CHESTER	90.3%	227	0	2	1
HAMBLEEN	90.2%	915	2	8	3
BRADLEY	90.2%	1,046	0	9	8
POLK	90.1%	162	0	2	2
MAURY	89.8%	1,130	3	5	8
JACKSON	89.5%	105	0	1	1
FENTRESS	89.4%	226	0	2	2
HAMILTON	89.1%	4,022	12	18	29
DECATUR	88.7%	115	0	1	1
LEWIS	86.4%	258	0	0	2

County	Students Fully Immunized in County (%)	Students in County	Schools with 95-100% Students in County Fully Immunized	Schools with 90-94% Students in County Fully Immunized	Schools with <90% Students in County Fully Immunized
UNION	85.6%	466	1	1	4
PICKETT	85.0%	40	0	0	0
GRUNDY	81.9%	149	0	1	3
VAN BUREN	64.3%	42	0	0	1

Appendix 2: Public and Private School Summaries by County and School District

The following tables and graphs describe data: 1) at the county-level, featuring information for both public and private schools within the county; and 2) at the school district level, featuring information for all schools within the school district. Data are presented by county in alphabetical order, with school districts nested under each respective county in alphabetical order, and schools nested under each respective school district in alphabetical order.